

"What Went Wrong?" — Setup guide (how to make each jar)

09-001 - NOT SAFE

Make this jar: Wide-mouth jar of pressure-canned green beans with a lid that pops up and down when pressed after cooling.

Visitors will see: Lid moves up and down when pressed, no vacuum seal. Possible cloudy liquid inside jar.

09-002 - DISCARD

Make this jar: A jar of tomatoes canned in a water bath without adding lemon juice or citric acid.

Visitors will see: Jar with a bulging lid, cloudy liquid, possibly some bubbles rising in the jar.

09-003 - NOT SAFE

Make this jar: Jar of home-canned green chili peppers processed in a boiling water bath instead of pressure canner.

Visitors will see: Jar lid sealed but liquid appears cloudy, possible floating pieces, and soft texture.

09-004 - SAFE

Make this jar: Jar of jam with white crystals forming on surface and around the edges inside.

Visitors will see: Visible white crystallization on surface and near the lid seal inside jar.

09-005 - DISCARD

Make this jar: Jar of home-canned carrots with evident mold growing on top of food inside jar.

Visitors will see: White cottony mold on surface inside jar and under the lid, possible off-odor when opened.

09-006 - NOT SAFE

Make this jar: Jar of low-acid vegetable pickles with liquid level far below 1/2 inch headspace.

Visitors will see: Liquid in jar does not fully cover vegetables; food exposed to air inside jar, with possible air bubbles rising.

09-007 - DISCARD

Make this jar: Jar of home-canned seafood with a leaking lid and liquid slime visible inside.

Visitors will see: Leaking jar, sticky or slimy liquid, foul odor upon opening.

09-008 - NOT SAFE

Make this jar: Jar of home-canned mushrooms processed in a water bath canner instead of pressure canner.

Visitors will see: Sealed jar with natural color but cloudy liquid, no visible signs of spoilage.

09-009 - SAFE

Make this jar: Jar of home-canned salsa with floating vegetable pieces at the top of the liquid.

Visitors will see: Vegetable pieces floating near the surface of the jar, liquid below them.

09-010 - NOT SAFE

Make this jar: Jar of home-canned pears with lid seal failure; lid easily lifts when pressed and liquid is leaking.

Visitors will see: Loose lid that lifts when pressed, liquid stains on jar side from leakage.

09-011 - SAFE

Make this jar: Jar of raw-pack canned plums in water, with floating fruit visible inside.

Visitors will see: Fruit pieces are floating near the top inside the jar instead of being evenly distributed or settled.

09-012 - SAFE

Make this jar: Jar of canned cherries with darkened, dull color compared to fresh fruit color.

Visitors will see: Fruit inside jar looks darker or brownish; color is not bright or fresh looking as expected.

09-013 - SAFE

Make this jar: Jar of home canned strawberry jam with white, gritty crystals on surface and inside the jam.

Visitors will see: Visible white or translucent crystals scattered throughout the jam.

09-014 - SAFE

Make this jar: Jar of pickles with cloudy brine inside, green cucumbers visible.

Visitors will see: Liquid brine in jar looks cloudy instead of clear; cucumbers appear normal.

09-015 - SAFE

Make this jar: Jar of home canned fruit pie filling with liquid level noticeably lower than when packed.

Visitors will see: Liquid covering fruit is low or missing, possibly fruit is exposed to air inside the jar.

09-016 - SAFE

Make this jar: Jar of canned peaches with fruit floating unevenly near the surface and liquid below.

Visitors will see: Some peach slices float at the top leaving gaps below, creating uneven liquid coverage.

09-017 - SAFE

Make this jar: Jam jar with thick jam showing slightly liquid watery layer separating on top after storage.

Visitors will see: Liquid or syrup separates and pools on top of jam, leaving a watery layer above thicker gel.

09-018 - SAFE

Make this jar: Jar of canned green beans with noticeably low liquid filling, some beans are exposed above liquid.

Visitors will see: Liquid level inside jar is low, not covering food as expected after processing.